



Entertainment & Fun

Movies, nightlife, festivals, and activities

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Article 1

Beijing Expat Bars: Where Foreigners Actually Hang Out (2026)

Tired of tourist traps? Here are the real bars where Beijing's expat community gathers -- with actual addresses you can put into your map app. These are the spots locals and long-term foreigners actually go to, not the places listed in generic travel guides.

Craft Beer & Breweries

* Great Leap Brewing #12 (大跃啤酒)

* Doujiao Hutong #6, Dongcheng District (东城区豆角胡同6号) 12:00-24:00 | ¥40-60/pint

Beijing's original craft brewery in a hutong courtyard. The Honey Ma Gold and Pale Ale

#6 are legendary. Gets packed on weekends. Outdoor seating in summer is the best vibe in Beijing.



* Website

* Slow Boat Brewery (悠航鲜啤)

* 56 Dongsi Shitiao, Dongcheng District (东城区东四十条56号) 16:00-00:00 | ¥45-65/pint

Award-winning IPAs and the best burger in Beijing (seriously). The Monkey Fist IPA won multiple international awards. Cozy interior with exposed brick.

* Website

* Jing-A Brewing Taproom (京A)

* Xingfucun Zhonglu, Building 19, Chaoyang District (朝阳区幸福村中路19号楼)

11:00-00:00 | ¥45-65/pint Best outdoor terrace in Beijing. Try the Flying Fist IPA and

Airpocalypse Double IPA. Great food menu too -- the pulled pork sandwich is solid.

Multiple locations but this is the OG.

* Website

* Arrow Factory Brewing (箭厂啤酒)

* 9 Jianchang Hutong, Dongcheng District (东城区箭厂胡同9号) 16:00-23:00 | ¥40-55/pint

Hidden gem in a quiet hutong near the Drum Tower. Small but quality-focused. The

Stout and Belgian Wit are excellent. Feels like a neighborhood secret.

* Website

* Panda Brew (熊猫精酿)

* 62 Dongsibei Dajie, Dongcheng District (东城区东四北大街62号) 14:00-00:00 |

¥35-50/pint Chinese-owned craft brewery with nationwide distribution. The taproom

has 20+ beers on rotation. Try the Honey Ale and Tangerine Wheat. Good for groups.

* Website

Cocktail Bars & Speakeasies

* Capital Spirits (首都烈酒)

* 3 Qianliang Hutong, Dongcheng District (东城区钱粮胡同3号) 19:00-02:00 |

¥60-90/cocktail China's first baijiu cocktail bar. Don't be scared -- the bartenders



transform baijiu into incredible cocktails. The "Baijiu Sour" converts skeptics. Tiny space, always buzzing. Reservations recommended.

* Website

* The Bar at The Opposite House (瑜舍)

* Building 1, Taikoo Li Sanlitun, Chaoyang District (朝阳区三里屯太古里1号楼) 17:00-01:00

| ¥80-120/cocktail Luxury hotel bar with stunning minimalist design. The cocktails are pricey but exceptional. Great for dates or impressing clients. The lobby bar has live DJ on weekends.

* Website

* Migas (米家思)

* 6/F, Nali Patio, 81 Sanlitun Road, Chaoyang District (朝阳区三里屯路81号那里花园6层)

18:00-02:00 | ¥70-100/cocktail Rooftop bar with incredible views of Sanlitun.

Spanish-inspired cocktails and tapas. The Sunday brunch is legendary among expats.

Summer rooftop parties are unmissable.



* Website

* Janes & Hooch

* 4 Gongti Beilu, Chaoyang District (朝阳区工体北路4号) 19:00-02:00 | ¥65-95/cocktail

Industrial-chic cocktail bar near Workers' Stadium. Excellent Old Fashioned and Negroni. The bartenders are serious about their craft. Gets lively after 11 PM on weekends.

* Amap

Live Music & Dive Bars

* DDC (Dusk Dawn Club 黄昏黎明俱乐部)

* 14 Shanlao Hutong, Dongcheng District (东城区山老胡同14号) 20:00-02:00 | ¥50-80

(cover varies) Beijing's best live jazz and indie music venue in a renovated hutong. Acts range from local jazz trios to touring international bands. The sound system is excellent for the intimate space.



* Website

* Temple Bar (寺庙酒吧)

* 206 Gulou Dong Dajie, Dongcheng District (东城区鼓楼东大街206号) 19:00-02:00 |

¥30-50/beer Dive bar with character near the Drum Tower. Cheap drinks, loud music, and a crowd of regulars who've been coming for years. The rooftop has a great view of the Drum Tower at night.

* The Beijinger

* The Den

* 4 Gongti Xilu, Chaoyang District (朝阳区工体西路4号) 18:00-02:00 | ¥40-60/beer Irish pub

that's been an expat institution for 20+ years. Sports on multiple screens, decent pub grub, and a reliable crowd. Wednesday quiz night is competitive.

* The Beijinger

* Paddy O'Shea's



* 28 Dongsì Shítiao, Dōngchéng District (东城区东四十条28号) 16:00-02:00 | ¥40-60/beer

The quintessential Irish pub in Beijing. Live sports, Guinness on tap, and a warm atmosphere. The go-to spot for watching Premier League matches with fellow expats.

* Website

Insider Tips:

* Hutong bars are best found by walking around -- many have no sign, just a red door

* Sanlitun gets touristy after midnight -- locals move to Gulou or Wudaokou

* Happy hour (5-8 PM) at most bars: 2-for-1 cocktails or ¥30 beers

* Use

* Amap (高德地图)

* to find hidden bars -- search "酒吧" + your area

* WeChat groups: search "Beijing expats" or "Beijing nightlife" for curated event listings



Sources: Sources: [The Beijinger](https://www.thebeijinger.com/blog) • [Great Leap Brewing](https://www.greatleapbrewing.com) • [Slow Boat](https://www.slowboatbrewing.com) • [Jing-A](https://www.jingabrewing.com)

Article 2

Shanghai Expat Bars: Where Foreigners Actually Hang Out (2026)

Shanghai has the best nightlife in mainland China, and the expat bar scene is legendary.

Here are the actual bars where Shanghai's foreign community gathers -- with real addresses you can Didi or metro to.

Bund & Riverside Bars

* Bar Rouge

* Bund 18, 7F, 18 Zhongshan Dong Yi Road, Huangpu District (黄浦区中山东一路18号7楼)

18:00-04:00 | ¥80-120/cocktail, ¥200+ cover on weekends The most iconic rooftop bar in

Shanghai. Unobstructed views of Pudong skyline. Dress to impress. Gets packed after 11

PM. The terrace is magical at sunset. This is THE expat party spot.



* Website

* The Nest

* Bund 18, 6F, 18 Zhongshan Dong Yi Road, Huangpu District (黄浦区中山东一路18号6楼)

18:00-02:00 | ¥90-130/cocktail More upscale than Bar Rouge, same building.

Nordic-inspired cocktails and food. The crowd is older, more sophisticated. Great for business entertaining. Reservations essential on weekends.

* Website

* Hakkasan

* Bund 18, 5F, 18 Zhongshan Dong Yi Road, Huangpu District (黄浦区中山东一路18号5楼)

18:00-01:00 | ¥100-150/cocktail World-renowned Cantonese restaurant with an

incredible bar. The cocktails are Asian-fusion masterpieces. Expensive but worth it for special occasions. Dress smart.

* Website



Former French Concession (法租界)

* The Public

* 101 Maoming Nan Road, Jing'an District (静安区茂名南路101号) 18:00-02:00 |

¥60-90/cocktail Legendary expat cocktail bar that's been around forever. The bartenders know everyone's name. Classic cocktails done right -- the Martini is perfect. Feels like a neighborhood living room. The crowd is 80% foreign.

* SmartShanghai

* Senator Saloon

* 98 Jianguo West Road, Xuhui District (徐汇区建国西路98号) 17:00-02:00 | ¥60-90/cocktail

American whiskey bar with the best bourbon selection in Shanghai. Dark wood, leather booths, and country music. The Old Fashioned is legendary. Always packed with Americans and Brits. No reservations -- first come, first served.

* SmartShanghai



* Flask

* 458 Shaanxi South Road, Xuhui District (徐汇区陕西南路458号) 19:00-02:00 |

¥70-100/cocktail Hidden speakeasy behind a Coca-Cola vending machine door. The cocktails are experimental and Instagram-worthy. Intimate space, max 30 people. Go early or wait in line. The "Tiki Flask" is their signature.

* SmartShanghai

* Epic Cocktail Bar

* Found 158, 158 Julu Road, Jing'an District (静安区巨鹿路158号Found 158) 19:00-02:00 |

¥65-90/cocktail Located in the Found 158 complex (a former underground bomb shelter turned bar street). Creative cocktails with Chinese ingredients. The bartenders are award-winning. Try the "Sichuan Negroni."

* SmartShanghai

* Sasha's

* 11 Hengshan Road, Xuhui District (徐汇区衡山路11号) 11:00-02:00 | ¥50-70/beer,



¥70-90/cocktail Set in a gorgeous 1920s heritage villa. The garden terrace is perfect for

Sunday brunch. Western food is solid. The crowd is a mix of expats and Chinese yuppies.

Live music on weekends.

* Website

Craft Beer & Brewpubs

* Daga Brewpub

* 57 Yuyuan Road, Jing'an District (静安区愚园路57号) 11:00-00:00 | ¥40-60/pint 30+ craft

beers on tap, mostly Chinese craft breweries. The outdoor seating on Yuyuan Road is great for people-watching. The IPA flight (4 x 150ml for ¥80) is the best way to explore.

Food is solid pub grub.

* Amap

* Boxing Cat Brewery (拳击猫)

* 519 Fuxing Middle Road, Xuhui District (徐汇区复兴中路519号) 11:00-00:00 | ¥45-65/pint



Shanghai's OG craft brewery. The TKO IPA and Sucker Punch Pale Ale are classics. Great American-style food. Multiple locations but this one has the best atmosphere.

* Website

* Tap House

* 398 Jiangsu Road, Changning District (长宁区江苏路398号) 16:00-00:00 | ¥40-55/pint

Neighborhood craft beer bar with a rotating tap list. The owner is a beer nerd who sources unique brews. Chill vibe, good music, and a friendly crowd. Perfect for a weeknight drink.

* SmartShanghai

Live Music & Late Night

* JZ Club

* 46 Fuxing West Road, Xuhui District (徐汇区复兴西路46号) 20:00-02:00 | ¥50-100 (cover varies) Shanghai's premier jazz club since 2004. World-class musicians play nightly. The



basement venue has incredible acoustics. Reservations recommended for weekends.

* Website

* Heyday Jazz Bar

* Ferguson Lane, 376 Wukang Road, Xuhui District (徐汇区武康路376号武康亭)

19:00-01:00 | ¥60-80/cocktail Intimate jazz bar in the beautiful Ferguson Lane complex.

More upscale than JZ Club. Great cocktails and a sophisticated crowd. Perfect for a date night.

* SmartShanghai

* Revolucion Cocktail

* 101 Maoming Nan Road, Jing'an District (静安区茂名南路101号) 20:00-04:00 |

¥60-90/cocktail Cuban-themed cocktail bar with live salsa music. The mojitos are legit.

Gets wild after midnight -- dancing on tables is not uncommon. Multiple locations but

Maoming Road is the original.

* Website



* Windows Garage

* 101 Maoming Nan Road, Jing'an District (静安区茂名南路101号) 20:00-02:00 |

¥40-60/beer Dive bar with live rock and indie bands. Sticky floors, cheap beer, and loud music -- exactly what you want at 1 AM. The crowd is a mix of expats, musicians, and night owls.

* SmartShanghai

Insider Tips:

* Former French Concession (Xuhui/Jing'an) has the highest density of expat bars -- walk between them

* Found 158 (巨鹿路158号) is a bar complex in a former bomb shelter -- multiple bars in one underground space

* Bund bars are expensive but worth it for the view -- go at sunset, leave before the cover charge kicks in



* Use

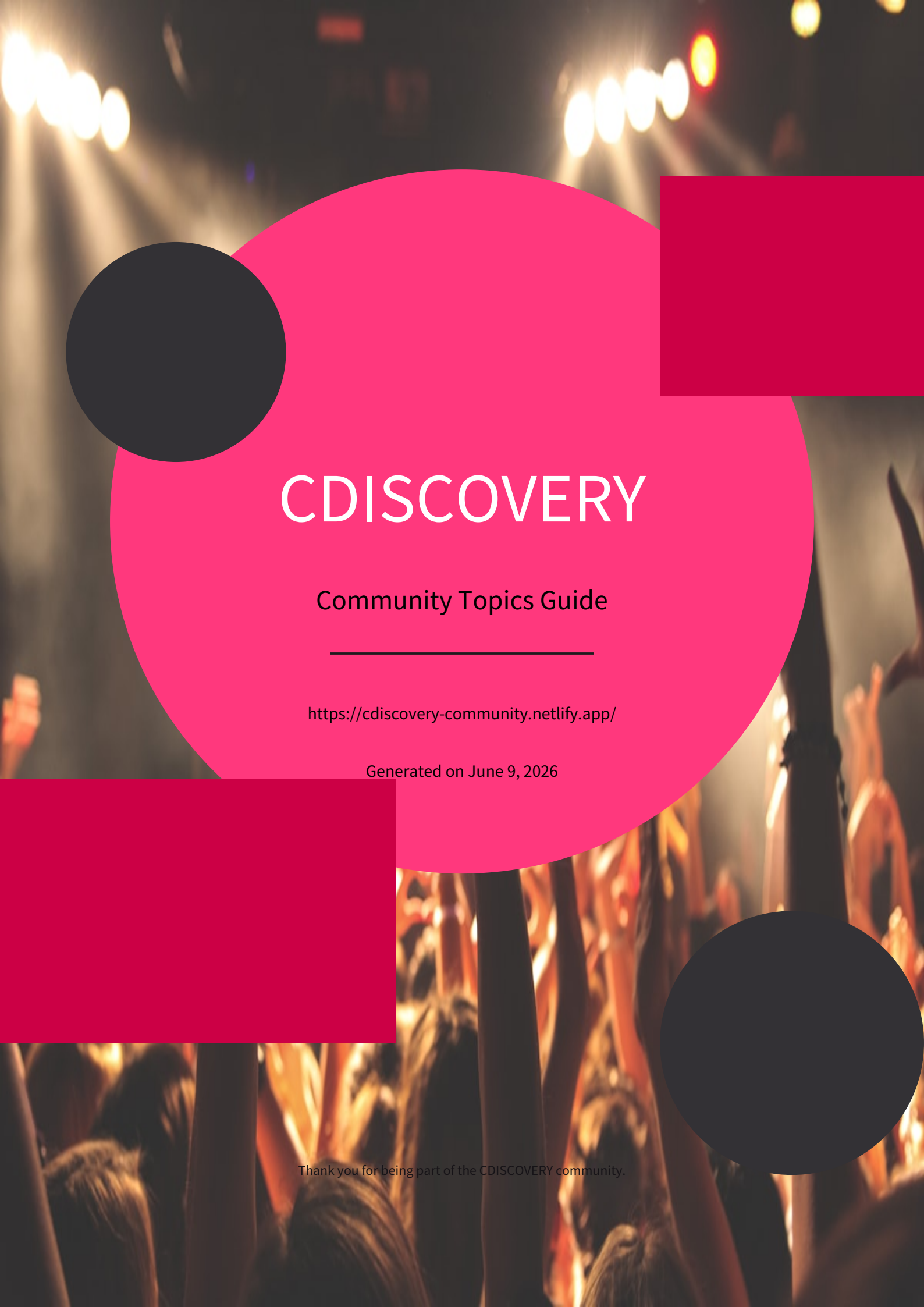
* SmartShanghai

* for weekly bar events and specials

* Didi is your friend after midnight -- metro closes at 11 PM

* WeChat: search "Shanghai expats" or "上海外国人" for party invites and event listings

Sources: Sources: [SmartShanghai](https://www.smartshanghai.com/venue/bars) • [Bar Rouge](https://www.barrouge-shanghai.com) • [Boxing Cat](https://www.boxingcatbrewery.com) • [JZ Club](https://www.jzclub.cn)

The background of the cover is a photograph of a crowd at a concert or festival, with many hands raised in the air. The scene is lit with warm, golden light from stage lights. Overlaid on this background are several geometric shapes: a large pink circle in the center, a smaller dark grey circle in the top left, a pink rectangle in the top right, a pink rectangle in the bottom left, and a dark grey circle in the bottom right.

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